e.g.potato, carrot. Foods should be salted or sweetened. Babies should have 600ml of breast or infant formula milk daily along with the weaning foods.

Stage II

Babies get used to spoon feeding and will take more solid foods. They can begin to have the same foods as the rest of the family, but in mashed or pureed form. They are able to chew foods at six months, so can be given hard foods to chew. These are called finger foods. These include foods such as raw soft fruits and vegetables, raw strips of carrot, cooked green beans and soft banana. Foods with increased quantity, different texture and stronger tastes should be encouraged.

Stage III

At this stage babies will probably eat solid foods in addition to 500-600ml breast milk or infant formula after nine months. Wide variety foods should be given with a range of textures, because the baby can cope up with food that is lumpier in texture.

Important points to be considered while introducing supplementary foods

→ Introduce only one food at a time.
→ Allow the infant to become familiar with the food before trying to give another.
→ Fruit juice should be fed only by cup not by bottle.
→ When the baby is able to chew, gradually substitute finely chopped fruit and vegetables usually at 8 to 9 months.
→ Variety in choice of foods is important.
→ Infants may object to eat some foods by themselves but will take them willingly if one is mixed with another. Egg may be mixed with formula cereal or vegetable.
→ The child can be fed with a spoon until the baby gets used to an adult method of feeding.
→ Give freshly prepared food.
→ Food should be given between breast feeds.
→ The temperature of the food should not be hot or cold.

Supplementary Foods

Foods that are regularly fed to the infant, in addition to breast-milk, providing sufficient nutrients are known as supplementary or complementary foods. These could be liquid foods like milk or semi-solid foods in the case of gruels or porridge or solid preparations like rice, which can be given to children over the age of one year.

Types of Supplementary Foods

Liquid Supplements

→ ***Milk:*** The frequency of breast feeding is reduced to 3 to 4 times a day and cow's milk is substituted in 6 months. Cow's milk is diluted with water in the proportion of 2:1 for the first feed. Sugar can be added to increase taste and calories.
→ ***Juice of Fresh Fruits:*** Small quantities of fresh fruit juices should be given in the 3rd and 4th month of the infant. In early stages fruit juice is diluted with water and only a couple of teaspoons are fed and the amount is gradually increased.
→ ***Soup from Green Leafy Vegetables:*** Green leafy vegetables can be

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